Reuben Luera

AI UX Researcher
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linkedin.com/in/reuben-luera | Google Scholar | 7 publications, 60 citations

Mixed-methods UX researcher with 5+ years across consumer tech, AI-assisted creative tools, and PC software at HP, Adobe Research, and Amazon, focused on how people trust, use, and evaluate AI. Owns research from intake and study design through moderation, analysis, and readouts that change product decisions. First-author work in Foundations and Trends in HCI and The Web Conference, with enough Python to build the research tooling.

EXPERIENCE

AI UX Researcher | HP | Apr 2026–Present | Palo Alto, CA

- Sole UX researcher supporting 7 designers on HP PC and OMEN gaming software, running 9+ concept value, expectation alignment, and A/B usability studies with 140+ participants on UserTesting.com.
- Built a human-in-the-loop AI research pipeline with Claude skills and Python that parses UserTesting exports, computes metrics, flags quality issues, and generates charted reports with verbatim quotes, while the researcher keeps control of exclusions, themes, and quote selection.
- Wrote reusable AI skills that turn PRDs into participant-safe study descriptions with audit trails, jargon logs, and QA checklists.
- Built an AI-maintained cross-study research knowledge base where findings gain confidence only when they replicate, and contradictions are logged instead of averaged away.
- Took one feature from written concept through prototype to hands-on usability testing; it met or beat expectations for 31 of 33 participants and scored 89 on QXscore, while flagging a help discoverability gap to fix before launch.

AI UX Researcher | ADOBE RESEARCH | May 2024–Dec 2025 | San Jose, CA

- Benchmarked multimodal LLMs (GPT-4o, Claude 3.5, Llama 3.2 Vision) against large-scale human judgments of UI qualities like clarity, trust, and visual hierarchy.
- Designed and ran human-in-the-loop evaluation pipelines across 30 real interfaces and 9 UI factors, collecting 15,000 human ratings (12,000 after quality filtering) through Likert scales and pairwise comparisons.
- Ran contextual inquiry and 3 RITE rounds of usability testing with 10 Creative Cloud designers; found the real pain was the export, paste, and re-import loop, not the AI itself.
- Ran a ~50,000-response Mechanical Turk study showing age, role, industry, and data experience shift whether people prefer charts, tables, or text, and recommended trait-based personalization for Adobe Customer Journey Analytics.

Product Designer & Researcher | STEALTH AI STARTUP | Nov 2024–Mar 2025 | Santa Monica, CA

- Led product design and UX research for a venture-backed ($2M) AI healthcare platform serving underserved communities, partnering with clinicians, engineers, and PMs to ship a patient-facing product.
- Ran 20+ usability tests of Figma prototypes on UserTesting and Lookback, iterating the flow until users could find and book appointments in under 60 seconds.

Product Designer and Researcher | AMAZON | Apr 2022–May 2024 | Los Angeles, CA

- Led mixed-methods research (25+ usability studies, observational sessions, and prototype tests) on viewing behavior and search intent for Fire TV Live TV, Fire Channels, and AI Search, directly informing personalization and AI Search launches.
- Drove research and redesign of the Fire TV Live Guide, contributing to a ~15% engagement lift on a guide used by 50M+ customers.
- One of two designers on Fire TV's generative AI search, shipped in 4 months, presented on the main stage at Amazon's device event, and covered by CNET.
- Partnered with applied science teams to bring LLM-backed ranking and retrieval into consumer TV search.

Founding Designer & Researcher | STASIS | Apr 2020–Mar 2022 | San Diego, CA

- Sole designer and researcher; ran golfer interviews, usability testing, and contextual inquiry that pivoted the product from an insole controller to a golf companion app, then designed the brand, website, and iOS app through launch.

EDUCATION

UC Berkeley | Master of Information Management and Systems (Emphasis: Mixed Methods Research) | Expected 2027

- Relevant coursework: UX for AI; INFO 290 (AI ethics and critical algorithm studies)

UC San Diego | BS in Cognitive Science (Emphasis in Human-Computer Interaction), Design Minor | Cum Laude | 2021

PUBLICATIONS

First author

- UI Design and Interactions for Generative AI Applications: A Survey | Foundations and Trends in HCI, 2025
- Personalizing Data Delivery: Investigating User Characteristics and Enhancing LLM Predictions | The Web Conference (WWW Companion), Sydney, 2025
- MLLM as a UI Judge: Benchmarking Multimodal LLMs for Predicting Human Perception of User Interfaces | IUI 2027 (under review)

Co-author

- A Survey on LLM-based Conversational User Simulation | EACL, 2026
- Figure Captioning with Large Generative Models: A Survey | Preprint, 2026 (second author)
- Model Routing for Large Language Models: A Unified Taxonomy and Survey | Preprint, 2026

SKILLS AND TOOLS

- **Research Skills:** In-depth interviews; contextual inquiry; diary studies; moderated and unmoderated usability testing; concept testing; RITE testing; think-aloud; observational research; journey mapping; personas; thematic analysis; synthesis; survey design; A/B testing; experimentation; Likert and pairwise studies; descriptive and inferential stats; MAE/MSE; rank correlation; benchmarking; SUS/QXscore; segmentation; data cleaning.
- **AI Research:** Human-AI interaction; LLM evaluation; LLM-as-judge benchmarking; human-AI alignment; human-in-the-loop pipelines; AI-assisted synthesis; prompt design; generative AI interaction patterns; responsible AI.
- **Research Operations:** Intake and triage; concurrent study management; screeners; protocols; question banks; research repositories; dashboards; recruiting coordination; participant care; privacy and consent.
- **Technical Skills:** Python (data analysis and pipeline scripting); Claude Code; Codex; NotebookLM; LaTeX; UserTesting.com, Lookback, dscout, Qualtrics, MAXQDA, Amazon Mechanical Turk, Tableau, Figma, FigJam, Miro, Sketch, Adobe Creative Suite, Obsidian.
- **Design:** Interaction design; prototyping; design systems; visual design; brand design.

AWARDS, PRESS, AND SPEAKING

- **GEM Fellow,** National GEM Consortium with Adobe, 2024; represented Adobe at the GEM Annual Board Meeting
- **Graduate Opportunity Program and Graduate Merit Fellowships,** UC Berkeley School of Information
- **Provost Honors,** UC San Diego Warren College
- **Press:** CNET (Fire TV conversational search); AFTVnews (Live Guide filtering update); Adobe Life video spotlight, 2025; Adobe Research GEM Fellows feature
- **Speaking:** The Web Conference 2025, short paper track presenter (Sydney); HACU 36th Annual Conference, panelist representing Amazon; Amazon device event main stage (AI Search, presented work); Friends of Figma "Ask a UX Design Intern" panel
- **Mentoring:** Mentored students at SMC and Amazon interns, with mentees placed at Disney